ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 7 · SET 02

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) Which of the following rivers flows westwards and drains into the Arabian Sea?

(A) Godavari (B) Narmada (C) Mahanadi (D) Krishna

> **Ans: (B)** The Narmada and Tapti flow west through rift valleys; the others flow east into the Bay of Bengal.

(ii) An anemometer is used to measure —

(A) air pressure (B) rainfall (C) wind speed (D) humidity

> **Ans: (C)** An anemometer has cups that spin with the wind.

(iii) The southwest monsoon first reaches the Indian mainland over the coast of —

(A) Gujarat (B) West Bengal (C) Punjab (D) Kerala

> **Ans: (D)** It usually arrives in Kerala around 1 June and then advances north.

(iv) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.
Statement I: Western disturbances bring winter rainfall to north-western India.
Statement II: Coastal places have a larger difference between day and night temperatures than inland places.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (A)** Statement II is wrong: the sea moderates temperatures, so coastal places have a smaller daily range.

(v) The number of Jyotirlingas, sacred shrines of Lord Shiva, traditionally counted in India is —

(A) 5 (B) 51 (C) 12 (D) 108

> **Ans: (C)** Somnath, Mahakaleshwar, Kedarnath, Rameswaram etc. make up the twelve Jyotirlingas.

(vi) The Golden Temple and the Akal Takht, a seat of Sikh authority, are located in —

(A) Amritsar (B) Ajmer (C) Patna (D) Nanded

> **Ans: (A)** Both are part of the Harmandir Sahib complex in Amritsar, Punjab.

(vii) The first Indian coins, made mostly of silver with symbols stamped on them, are called —

(A) dinaras (B) tankas
(C) paper notes (D) punch-marked coins

> **Ans: (D)** They were used from the time of the mahajanapadas (about 2,500 years ago).

(viii) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.

Assertion (A): After the Kalinga war, Ashoka gave up conquest by war.

Reason (R): He was deeply moved by the death and suffering that the war had caused.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect

(B) A is incorrect, R is correct

(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A

(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** R correctly explains A; Ashoka turned to dhamma.

(ix) The three well-known kingdoms of the Sangam age in southern India were —

(A) Cholas, Palas and Pratiharas (B) Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas

(C) Guptas, Cheras and Pandyas (D) Shungas, Kanvas and Satavahanas

> **Ans: (B)** They flourished in Tamil Nadu and Kerala and traded with Rome and Southeast Asia.

(x) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option.

1. Faxian visits India
2. Chandragupta Maurya founds the Maurya empire
3. Gupta era begins under Chandragupta I
4. Kalinga war fought by Ashoka

(A) 4, 2, 3, 1 (B) 2, 4, 3, 1 (C) 2, 3, 4, 1 (D) 2, 4, 1, 3

> **Ans: (B)** Correct order: Chandragupta Maurya (321 BCE) → Kalinga war (261 BCE) → Gupta era begins (320 CE) → Faxian's visit (c. 405 CE).

(xi) Which Gupta-age scholar suggested that the Earth rotates on its own axis?

(A) Kalidasa (B) Varahamihira (C) Panini (D) Aryabhata

> **Ans: (D)** Aryabhata also worked on the value of pi and eclipses.

(xii) A government in which one person holds all power and is not answerable to the people is a —

(A) dictatorship (B) democracy

(C) constitutional monarchy (D) federation

> **Ans: (A)** A dictator rules without accountability to the people.

(xiii) The Chairman of the Drafting Committee of the Constituent Assembly was —

(A) Dr Rajendra Prasad (B) Jawaharlal Nehru

(C) Dr B. R. Ambedkar (D) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

> **Ans: (C)** Dr Rajendra Prasad was the President of the Constituent Assembly.

(xiv) Currency notes of ₹ 10, ₹ 20, ₹ 100 and above in India are issued by the —

(A) State Bank of India (B) Ministry of Education

(C) NITI Aayog (D) Reserve Bank of India

> **Ans: (D)** RBI is the central bank and regulates the currency.

(xv) A market in which goods are sold to the final consumers in small quantities is a —

(A) wholesale market (B) stock market

(C) retail market (D) export market

> **Ans: (C)** Retail shops sell directly to consumers.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) What is a tirtha? Give one example of a tirtha in India.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - A tirtha is a sacred place, often by a river/sea/mountain, where one can 'cross over' (from the worldly to the spiritual) — 1 mark
> - Example: Varanasi/Haridwar/Rameswaram/Pushkar (any one) — 1 mark

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2.(B) State any two ways in which pilgrimage helps in the unity of India.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - People from different regions meet and share traditions
> - Sacred places in all four directions connect the whole country
> - Trade, travel and cultural exchange follow pilgrim routes
> - Shared festivals like Kumbh, Wari, Rath Yatra (any two, 1 mark each)

3.(A) How does altitude affect the climate of a place? Give one example from India.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Temperature decreases with height (about 6.5 °C per 1000 m) — 1 mark
> - Example: Shimla/Ooty is cooler than the plains at the same latitude — 1 mark

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3.(B) Why does the windward side of the Western Ghats receive heavy rainfall?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Moist winds from the Arabian Sea are forced to rise along the slopes — 1 mark
> - They cool, condense and give heavy rain (relief rainfall) — 1 mark

4. Differentiate between a wholesale market and a retail market (any two points).

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Wholesale: goods in bulk; buyers are traders/retailers; lower price per unit
> - Retail: small quantities; buyers are consumers; higher price per unit
> - Wholesale markets are mostly in mandis/large godowns; retail in shops/haats/malls (any two points, 1 mark each)

5.(A) Name any two mahajanapadas along with their capitals.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Magadha – Rajagriha (later Pataliputra)
> - Kosala – Shravasti
> - Avanti – Ujjayini (Ujjain)
> - Vatsa – Kaushambi
> - Gandhara – Taxila (any two correct pairs, 1 mark each)

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5.(B) Why were cities of the Second Urbanisation surrounded by walls and moats?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - To protect the city and its ruler from enemy attacks — 1 mark
> - To control entry and exit and collect taxes on goods — 1 mark

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe any three achievements of the Gupta period in the field of science, literature or art.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Aryabhata — rotation of the Earth, value of pi, decimal system
- Varahamihira — wrote the Brihat Samhita on astronomy and nature
- Kalidasa — wrote Meghaduta and Abhijnanashakuntalam
- Ajanta cave paintings and temple architecture
- Iron Pillar of Delhi — advanced metallurgy
- Nalanda became a famous centre of learning

OR

6.(B) Explain any three features of the economy of the Gupta period.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Agriculture was the main occupation; land grants were given to Brahmins and temples
- Trade within India and with other countries was active
- Gold coins (dinaras) were issued in large numbers
- Guilds of artisans and merchants worked in cities
- Faxian wrote that people were prosperous

7.(A) Explain any three problems faced under the barter system and how money solved them.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Double coincidence of wants — money is accepted by everyone
- Difficulty in dividing goods — money comes in small and large units
- Difficulty of storing and carrying goods — money is light and durable
- No common measure of value — money gives prices to all goods

OR

7.(B) How did the use of coins make trade easier in ancient India? Give three points.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Coins were light, durable and easy to carry
- They had a fixed value stamped by the ruler or guild
- Taxes and wages could be paid in coins
- Traders could save and lend money; long-distance trade grew
- Coins serve as evidence for historians (rulers, deities, trade)

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain the meaning of any five key words of the Preamble of the Indian Constitution.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Sovereign — India is free to take its own decisions
- Socialist — reduce inequality; fair share of wealth
- Secular — no official religion; equal respect for all faiths
- Democratic — rule by the people through elections
- Republic — the head of state is elected, not hereditary
- Justice, Liberty, Equality, Fraternity — the four ideals to be secured

OR

8.(B) Describe any five Fundamental Duties of Indian citizens.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Abide by the Constitution and respect the National Flag and Anthem
- Protect the sovereignty, unity and integrity of India
- Promote harmony and the spirit of brotherhood
- Preserve our rich heritage and culture
- Protect the environment, forests, lakes, rivers and wildlife
- Safeguard public property; develop scientific temper

9.(A) Explain any five features of the Sangam age (Cholas, Cheras, Pandyas).

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- 'Sangam' means an assembly of poets and scholars, mostly in Madurai
- Sangam literature gives a picture of society, kings and trade
- The Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas ruled Tamilakam
- Famous ports and trade with Rome and Southeast Asia
- Pandyas were known for pearls from the Gulf of Mannar
- Irrigation works like the Kallanai on the Kaveri
- Kings were praised for generosity and bravery

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9.(B) Describe any five features of the Satavahana rule in the Deccan.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- They ruled the Deccan for more than 300 years after the Mauryas
- Gautamiputra Satakarni was their most powerful ruler
- Controlled trade routes between north and south and ports on the west coast
- Issued coins with ships and other symbols showing sea trade
- Cave monasteries at Karle, Nashik and Naneghat inscriptions
- Supported Buddhism and Vedic traditions both

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Gram Sabha: In every village, all adult voters make up the Gram Sabha. It meets at least twice a year to discuss the village budget, schemes such as roads and water supply, and the work of the Gram Panchayat. The Sarpanch, elected by the villagers, leads the Gram Panchayat. The 73rd Constitutional Amendment (1992) gave Panchayati Raj institutions constitutional status.

(10.1) Who forms the Gram Sabha?

All the adult voters of the village.

(10.2) Who leads the Gram Panchayat?

The Sarpanch.

(10.3) Why is the Gram Sabha important for democracy at the grassroots level?

(1) It lets ordinary villagers take part in decisions about local matters; (1) it makes the Panchayat accountable by letting people question its work and budget.

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> An inscription of Ashoka says that when he conquered Kalinga, about one lakh fifty thousand persons were taken away as captives, one lakh were killed and many more died. After this, the king felt deep sorrow and regret. He declared that he would now win people by dhamma and not by war.

(11.1) Which war is mentioned in the passage?

> The Kalinga war.

(11.2) What was the effect of the war on Ashoka?

> He felt remorse and gave up conquest by war.

(11.3) How do inscriptions like this help historians?

> (1) They give the king's own words and policies; (1) they are dated, durable evidence of events, rulers and ideas of the time.

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> A farmer in Nashik sells onions at ₹ 18 per kg to a wholesaler at the mandi. The wholesaler sells them at ₹ 24 per kg to a retail shopkeeper after paying for transport and storage. The shopkeeper sells them to the consumer at ₹ 30 per kg.

(12.1) At what price does the consumer buy one kg of onions?

> ₹ 30 per kg.

(12.2) Name the two intermediaries between the farmer and the consumer.

> The wholesaler and the retailer.

(12.3) Why does the consumer pay more than the farmer receives? Give two reasons.

> Any two (1 mark each): transport and storage costs; wholesaler's and retailer's profit/margin (₹ 6 each); risk of spoilage; rent and labour costs of shops.

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Rivers, mountains and forests have always been regarded as sacred in India. The Ganga rises at Gaumukh near Gangotri in the Himalaya, flows through the plains and is worshipped by crores of people. Pilgrims visit sacred places such as Haridwar, Varanasi and Prayagraj to bathe and perform rituals, and many walk long distances to reach the sacred source.

(13.1) Where does the river Ganga rise?

> At Gaumukh (Gangotri glacier) in the Himalaya (Uttarakhand).

(13.2) Name two sacred places on the banks of the Ganga from the passage.

> Haridwar, Varanasi, Prayagraj (any two).

(13.3) How does this passage show a link between geography and culture?

> (1) Natural features such as rivers and mountains are regarded as sacred and are woven into belief; (1) the geography decides routes and places of pilgrimage, and care for rivers is a part of culture.

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Dwarka
(II) Puri
(III) Haridwar
(IV) Varanasi
(V) Ajanta Caves
(VI) Amritsar

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Dwarka located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Puri located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Haridwar located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Varanasi located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Ajanta Caves located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Amritsar located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Dwarka — **Gujarat**
- (II) Puri — **Odisha**
- (III) Haridwar — **Uttarakhand**
- (IV) Varanasi — **Uttar Pradesh**
- (V) Ajanta Caves — **Maharashtra**
- (VI) Amritsar — **Punjab**

